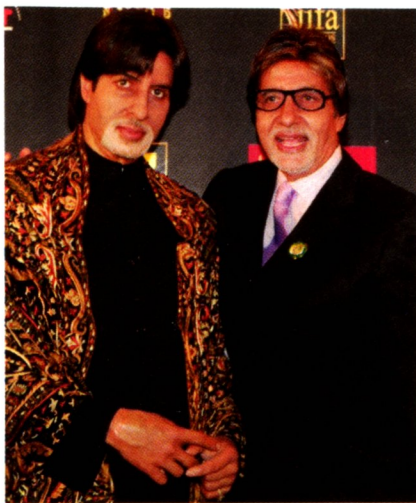


Starry NIGHTS

Sushmita Sen gambled, Lara Dutta shopped, Abhishek Bachchan cried and Sonam Kapoor danced at the recently held IIFA weekend in Macau

By Jhilmil Motihar in Macau

At the witching hour of 4 a.m., director Madhur Bhandarkar was in deep conversation with actor R. Madhavan. Five feet away, Anil Kapoor was standing with brow furrowed. At a stone's throw, Neil Nitin Mukesh was waiting for his fate to take a right turn. All four were trying their luck. Because for the three days of the International Indian Film Academy (IIFA) Award show at The Venetian, Macau, all the drama was at the hotel's casino. Seeing Bhandarkar there, a smart alec declared, "Madhur's found his next subject. It's



BIG B POSES WITH THE MADAME TUSSAUDS WAX WORK AT IIFA

called Casino." Kapoor had bet his money on roulette but by the look on his face, his bank account wasn't swelling. In a corner of the casino where photography wasn't allowed, Minissha Lamba and cricketer S. Sreesanth indulged in some serious public display of affection. Sreesanth won HK \$3,000 and soon the cricketer and his date moved to the bar.

Just the night before, Boman Irani had won HK \$10,000. Lara Dutta tried her hand at blackjack but promptly moved to roulette. But far away from

And the awards go to.....



Everyone knew Sreesanth was there. No one knew why. To see Minissha, maybe?

Misplaced Celeb Award

Quirky Chic Award

REUTERS



Sonam's style soared. From a kitschy Manish Arora dress to a Grecian Anamika Khanna toga, the actor ditched the gown-sari routine to mix it up.



Govinda rehearsed, wife Sunita shopped with son but daughter Narmadaa hit the gym every day.

Fitness Freak Award

Shopholic Award

Lara Dutta hit the hotel shopping arcade pronto. She even wore the blue Club Monaco dress she bought a day earlier.

Shady Guy Award

The events were held indoors. Yet Resul Pookutty refused to part with his shades. He perched them on his head even while collecting his trophy.



Great Gambler Award

To Sushmita Sen, one of the few to have gambled at the high rollers den.